



🔍 Search Help Center

[HOME](#) > [TIME & ATTENDANCE](#) > [GET STARTED WITH TIME TRACKING](#)

Review and approve or reject time entries as an admin

This article is for:



ADMINISTRATORS



TIME & ATTENDANCE

In this article

Objective

Review time entries

Approve or reject time entries

Override a time entry approval process

Bulk approve or reject time entries



Approve or reject a time entry in a pay run

Approve or un-approve timecards in the Rippling mobile app

Frequently asked questions

See also

Objective

Super, full, Payroll, and Time & Attendance admins can review and approve time entries for all employees. Learn more about Rippling permission profiles in this article about [creating and assigning a permission profile](#).

Review time entries

The instructions for how to review time entries vary depending on where you're viewing the time entry:

- The new Timesheets experience
- The legacy Timecards experience

Review time entries in the new Timesheets experience

To review time entries in the new Timesheets experience, follow these steps:

1. From the main sidebar, select **Time**.
2. From the *Time* sidebar, select **Timesheets**.
3. Search for the worker whose time entries you want to review.

Employee name	Approvers	Total hours	Overtime ...	Unapproved ...	Pay period	Pay schedule	Country
Dustin Barton		52h 44m	12h 30m	0m	04/27/2026 - 05/03/20...	No pay schedule	
Dustin Barton		52h 41m	12h 55m	0m	05/04/2026 - 05/10/20...	No pay schedule	
Dustin Barton		6h 4m	0m	6h 4m	05/11/2026 - 05/17/20...	No pay schedule	

4. Optionally, use the options at the top to filter by country, pay schedule, schedule, and/or time range.
5. Click the **> arrow** to the far right of the timesheet that contains the time entries you want to review.

Review timecards in the legacy Timecards experience

To review timecards in the legacy Timecards experience, follow these steps:

1. From the main sidebar, select **Time**.
2. From the *Time* sidebar, select **Timecards**.
3. Optionally, type the worker's name in the *Search* field to display just that worker's timecards.

Approve or reject time entries

The instructions for how to approve or reject time entries vary depending on where you're viewing the time entry:

- The new Timesheets experience
- The legacy Timecards experience

Note: You can edit a time entry before approving. Learn more in this article about [editing a time entry](#).

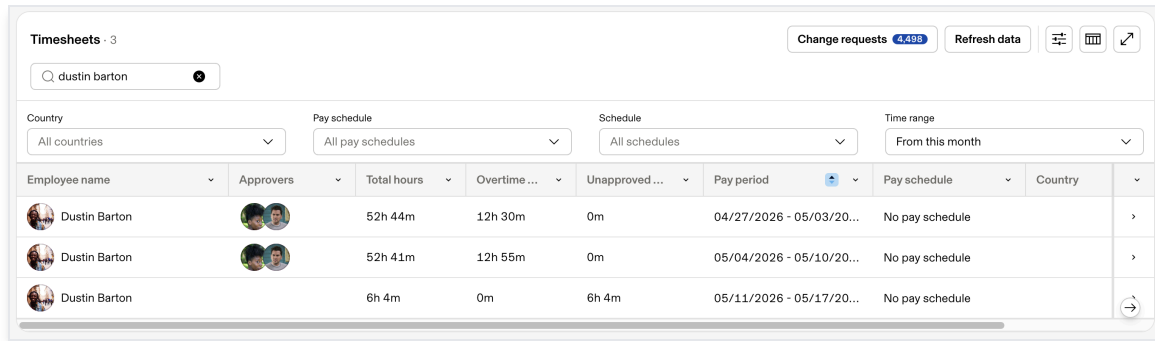
Note: Rejected time entries do not sync to Payroll and are not included in overtime calculations. In addition, rejecting a time entry does not remove its

hours from the *Total Worked Hours* section in the Timecard or Timesheet summary. To ensure those hours are not included in the summary, the time entry must be removed. Learn more in this article about [editing or removing a time entry](#).

Approve or reject time entries in the new Timesheets experience

To approve or reject time entries in the new Timesheets experience, follow these steps:

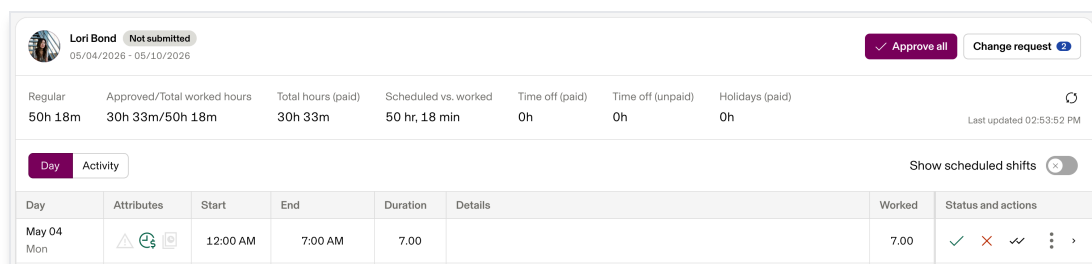
1. From the main sidebar, select **Time**.
2. From the *Time* sidebar, select **Timesheets**.
3. Search for the worker whose time entries you want to approve or reject.



The screenshot shows the 'Timesheets' interface for a user named 'dustin barton'. At the top, there are filters for Country (All countries), Pay schedule (All pay schedules), Schedule (All schedules), and Time range (From this month). Below the filters is a table with columns: Employee name, Approvers, Total hours, Overtime, Unapproved, Pay period, Pay schedule, and Country. The table lists three time entries for Dustin Barton, each with a 'No pay schedule' status and a right arrow icon for actions.

Employee name	Approvers	Total hours	Overtime	Unapproved	Pay period	Pay schedule	Country
Dustin Barton	[Avatar]	52h 44m	12h 30m	0m	04/27/2026 - 05/03/20...	No pay schedule	
Dustin Barton	[Avatar]	52h 41m	12h 55m	0m	05/04/2026 - 05/10/20...	No pay schedule	
Dustin Barton		6h 4m	0m	6h 4m	05/11/2026 - 05/17/20...	No pay schedule	

4. Optionally, use the options at the top to filter by country, pay schedule, schedule, and/or time range.
5. Click the **> arrow** to the far right of the timesheet that contains the time entries you want to approve or reject.
6. In the *Status and actions* column for the respective time entry, you have the following options:
 - **Approve:** Click the **green check mark icon** to approve the time entry.
 - **Reject:** Click the **red X icon** to reject the time entry.
 - **Override approval:** Click the **two black check mark icon** to override the approval process and approve the time entry. Learn more about overriding approvals in the *Override a time entry approval process* section below.



The screenshot shows the 'Status and actions' column for a time entry. It includes a 'Day' tab and an 'Activity' tab. Below the tabs is a table with columns: Day, Attributes, Start, End, Duration, Details, Worked, and Status and actions. The 'Status and actions' column contains icons for 'Approve all', 'Change request', and 'Not submitted'.

Day	Attributes	Start	End	Duration	Details	Worked	Status and actions
May 04 Mon	[Icons]	12:00 AM	7:00 AM	7.00		7.00	[Icons]

Approve or reject time entries in the legacy Timecards experience

To approve or reject time entries in the legacy Timecards experience, follow these steps:

1. From the main sidebar, select **Time**.
2. From the *Time* sidebar, select **Timecards**.
3. Optionally, type the worker's name in the *Search* field to display just that worker's timecards.
4. Click the worker's name.
5. Rippling defaults to a Timecards view, which shows logged hours by day and time.

Tip: To view the time entries on a timeline, click **View as:** and select **View as: Timeline**. The same time entry approval options are available on this view.

6. You can approve time entries using one of the following methods:
 - **Approve an individual shift:** Click the **green checkmark** in a time entry's row.
 - **Approve all shifts in the timecard:** Click **Approve all** to approve all time entries across all days, for this specific employee's timecard. For managers, the *Approve all* button is disabled unless they are the assigned approver for all of the listed time entries.

Note: If you are an admin who is part of a multi-step approval process, clicking *Approve all* will not automatically move the shift to the approved status because not all approvers in the approval process have approved the shift. To override the defined approval process and approve the shift, click **Override all**.

- **Override and approve all shifts in the timecard:** If you are a Time admin you can override the defined approval process and approve all of the shifts. This is true even if there is a multi-step approval process and other members of the approval chain have not yet approved them. To do so, click **Override all**.

View as: Timecards (Default)
☐ Show only unapproved entries
Override all
Approve all
New entry

Timecards - 2
Export CSV

Alerts	Date	Status		Shift Clock in	Clock out	Duration	Hours Regular	
	Thursday August 21	Pending approval	✓ ✗ ⋮	09:13 AM AKDT	07:16 PM AKDT	10h 3m	8h	1.
	Tuesday August 19	Approved	✓ ✗ ⋮	04:30 AM AKDT	06:48 PM AKDT	14h 18m	8h	6

Tip: Click **Show only unapproved entries**, next to the *View as:* selector, to hide approved time entries and only display time entries in the *Pending approval* or *Rejected* status.

Tip: To review and approve or reject the next employee's timecard, click the > **arrow** in the upper right next to *[x] of [x] employees*.

Override a time entry approval process

In most cases, super admins can approve any time entry, regardless of who the designated approvers are. The exception is when an employee is on a multi-step approval policy and the super admin is assigned to step 2 or later. In that case, the super admin's approval is recorded, but the time entry still requires approval from each earlier step in sequence before it is fully approved.

Review the time entry approval policy the employee is assigned to

To review the time entry approval policy the employee is assigned to, follow these steps:

1. From the main sidebar, select **Time**.
2. From the *Time* sidebar, select **Policies**.
3. Select the **Approval** tab > **Timecards** sub-tab.
4. Find the relevant policy and click its > **arrow**.

5. Review the approval policy's approval steps.

Override a time entry approval process

Super admins, Time & Attendance admins, and users with the *Manage the Time & Attendance app* permission can override the approval process and approve any time entry, regardless of their position in the approval chain.

To override a time entry approval, follow these steps:

1. From the main sidebar, select **Time**.
2. From the *Time* sidebar, select **Approvals**.
3. Select the **Needs review** tab > **Timecards** sub-tab.
4. Locate the time entry row in the table and click the corresponding > **arrow**.
5. Click **Override approval process**.
6. Click **Approve** (or **Reject**) to confirm that this will immediately approve (or reject) the request and cancel any pending tasks for other approvers

Bulk approve or reject time entries

To bulk approve or reject time entries across multiple workers, follow these steps:

1. From the main sidebar, select **Time**.
2. From the *Time* sidebar, select **Approvals**.
3. Select the **Needs review** tab > **Timecards** sub-tab.
4. Place a checkmark next to each time entry you want to take the same action on.

Approvals

Needs review 67 My requests Reviewed All requests

Time off Timecards 65 Shift edits 2 Shift drops Shift covers

Time entry requests

Q Search by name Filter

Request...	Requested by	Shift start time	Shift end time	Shift duration	Alerts	Attributes	
☒ Mar 30, 2026	 Vincent Howell Account Manager	March 30 02:58 PM CEST	March 31 02:56 AM CEST	11h 58m		 	☒ ☒ ☒
☒ Mar 30, 2026	 Alec Macdonald Account Manager	March 30 02:06 PM BST	March 31 12:56 AM BST	10h 50m		 	☒ ☒ ☒
☒ Mar 30, 2026	 Andrea Villa Account Manager	March 30 03:17 PM CEST	March 31 03:56 AM CEST	12h 39m		 	☒ ☒ ☒
☒ Mar 30, 2026	 Michael Graves Account Manager	March 30 02:55 PM CEST	March 31 04:56 AM CEST	14h 1m		 	☒ ☒ ☒
☐ Mar 30, 2026	 Samantha Taylor Account Manager	March 30 01:56 PM BST	March 31 02:56 AM BST	13h		 	☒ ☒ ☒
☒ Mar 30, 2026	 Ricky Alexander Account Manager	March 30 01:55 PM BST	March 31 02:56 AM BST	13h 1m		 	☒ ☒ ☒
☒ Mar 30, 2026	 Monica Crawford Account Manager	March 30 01:55 PM BST	March 31 02:56 AM BST	13h 1m		 	☒ ☒ ☒
☒ Mar 30, 2026	 Steven May Account Manager	March 30 09:02 AM EDT	March 30 07:56 PM EDT	10h 54m		 	☒ ☒ ☒
☐ Mar 30, 2026	 Deanna Wilson Account Manager	March 30 01:56 PM BST	March 31 02:56 AM BST	13h		 	☒ ☒ ☒
☐ Mar 30, 2026	 Steven May Account Manager	March 30 09:02 AM EDT	March 30 07:56 PM EDT	10h 54m		 	☒ ☒ ☒

7/65 selected Select all (65) Approve Reject

5. Click **Approve** or **Reject** in the bottom center of your screen.

Approve or reject a time entry in a pay run

Note: Only [super, full, or Payroll admins](#) can approve hours directly within a pay run in the Payroll app.

To approve or reject a time entry in a pay run, follow these steps:

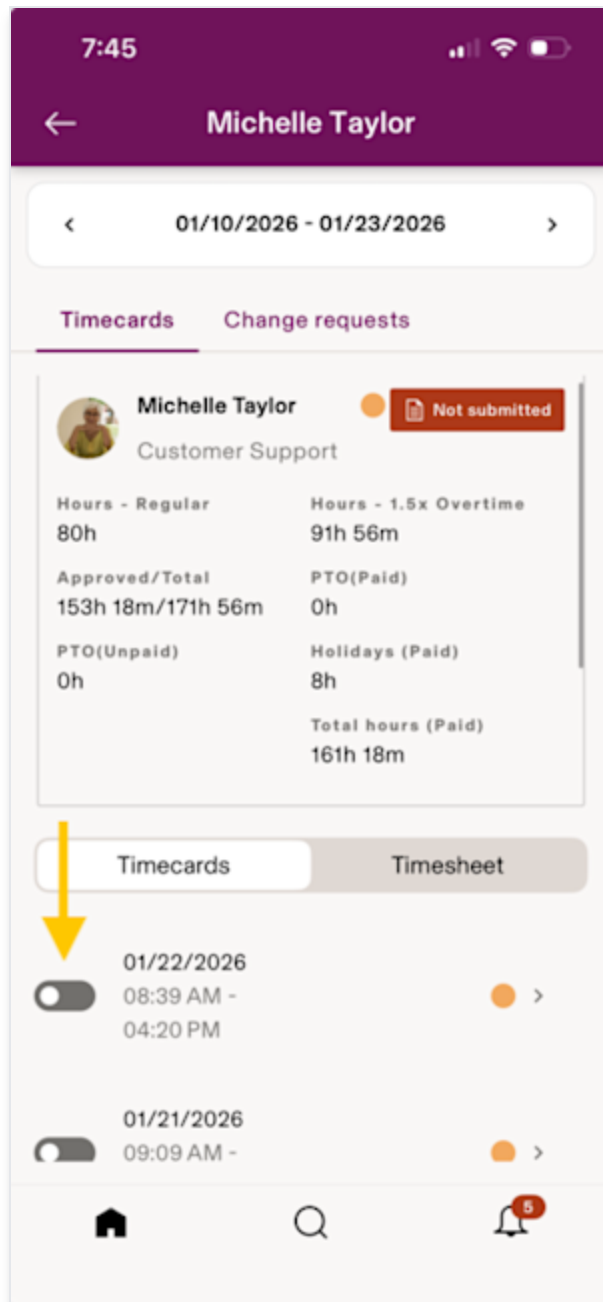
1. From within a pay run, select the **Earnings** tab.
2. Search for the worker by name.
3. Click the worker's name.
4. Ensure the **Time Tracking** tab > **Time entries** sub-tab are selected.
5. Click the time entry's corresponding **green check mark** to approve or **red X icon** to reject the time entry.

Approve or un-approve timecards in the Rippling mobile app

Admins and managers can approve or un-approve employee timecards directly from the Rippling mobile app.

To approve or un-approve employee timecards in the Rippling mobile app, follow these steps:

1. On the mobile dashboard, under *HR*, select **Time and Attendance**.
2. Tap **Timecards**.
3. Use the toggle switch associated with each timecard to:
 - **Approve:** Toggle the switch to the right to approve the timecard.
 - **Un-approve:** Toggle the switch to the left to un-approve the timecard.



Frequently asked questions

What happens if hours are not approved in time for payroll?

Employees are not paid for unapproved hours. For this reason, it's essential the employee's manager or an admin approve the employee's time entries *before* approving payroll. That said, if you've approved payroll but still have some unapproved hours, you can make adjustments in Rippling.

Missing hours

If you've approved payroll but still have unapproved hours, your next steps to approve hours varies by the pay run status:

- **Pay run = Approved.** If the pay run's status is *Approved*, you can unsubmit the pay run. In the pay run, click **Unsubmit Pay Run**. Once you've unsubmitted the original run, newly-approved time entries will sync to payroll and you can re-approve the pay run.
- **Pay run = Paid.** If the pay run has already been paid, then Rippling will automatically generate an *Extra hours* payroll to capture employee time entries that were approved after the pay run was approved.

Overpaid hours

If employees were overpaid and the pay run status is already *Paid* (i.e. you can no longer unsubmit the pay run), then you can create a [payroll correction](#) to reduce the employee's earnings. We recommend this path because the correction will recalculate taxes owed, and log those changes in our system. If you're not familiar with payroll corrections in Rippling, we recommend reading our [payroll corrections overview guide](#).

If you do not want to create a payroll correction but still need to recoup the employee funds, you can also change the employee's [post-tax deductions](#) in a future payroll to recoup the overpaid funds.

Why did an employee's past time entries move to *No Pay Schedule* after I changed their start date?

When an employee's start date is changed to a future date, Rippling considers them inactive for all dates before the new start date. Since an employee must be active in the system to be assigned to a pay schedule, their previous time entries are moved to the *No Pay Schedule* category, and time entries in this category do not sync to Payroll upon approval. This only impacts time entries that are in the pending or approved status. Time entries that are already in the paid status remain under the pay schedule they were processed with.

Once the employee's new start date is reached and they become active again, Rippling automatically assigns the time entries to the correct pay schedule based on the pay schedule membership configuration.

If I change the approver, what happens to pending time entry approvals?

If you change the approver, unapproved (pending approval) time entries remain the responsibility of the approver at the time the time entry was submitted. Time entries pending approval before the change of approver are not automatically rerouted to the new approver.

The new approver will begin receiving approval requests for time entries submitted from the date the approver change was made.

Can I view an employee's total paid hours when reviewing a time entry for approval?

Yes. When reviewing a time entry for approval, you can view an employee's total paid hours for a time entry, including the breakdown of paid hours and unpaid breaks, by reviewing the employee's time entry in the new Timesheets experience or the employee's timecard in the legacy Timecard experience.

When viewing an employee's timesheet (new Timesheet experience), click the **> arrow** associated with the time entry you want to review the total paid hours. The total paid

hours are displayed in the *Breakdown* section.

When viewing an employee's timecard (legacy Timecards experience), the table listing the time entries includes columns for hours (regular, overtime, etc.) and unpaid breaks.

I didn't get notified a time entry required my approval. Why?

You must enable timecard approval reminders in order to be notified a time entry requires your approval. To enable these notifications, follow the steps in [our article about managing your notification preferences](#).

An employee has been terminated in Rippling with a last day of work in the future and I need to process their final termination pay run, but the dates they need to add hours for in the next pay period are greyed out. How do I handle this?

Employees can only add time entries for dates within an active pay period. Dates in a future or inactive pay period are greyed out. To process the employee's final termination pay run, you can choose to:

- **Wait for the next pay period to become active:** Once the pay period opens, the employee can add the missing hours for the required dates.
- **Make a manual adjustment:** If the hours need to be included immediately for the final termination pay run, an admin can manually add or adjust the hours directly in the pay run. This ensures the termination payroll reflects all hours worked.

Note: While processing the termination, make sure the employee's access revoke date is set after their last workday. This allows the employee to retain access to Rippling and enter hours until that date if needed.

See also

Learn more in these related resources:

- [Overview of time tracking approvals](#)
- [Review and approve or reject time entries as a manager](#)

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